# Bible Syllabus — Junior High

**2026–2027**

## INSTRUCTOR INFORMATION

| Instructor | Email | Room Location & Hours |
|---|---|---|
| Kirsten Decker | Kirsten@rivertech.me | Dance Hall — Fridays, 11:05-11:45 AM |

## GENERAL INFORMATION

### Description

This course walks Junior High students through Scripture using different reflection methods each quarter: S.O.A.P., 3-2-1 reflections, a Two Truths and a Feeling study of the Sermon on the Mount, and Interview the Character studies of major biblical figures. The goal is to build a weekly habit of reading, reflecting, and applying Scripture.

### Expectations and Goals

Students are expected to bring their Bible and journal to class each week, complete that week's reflection using the assigned method, and participate in class discussion. By the end of the year, students should have a consistent habit of personal Bible study, be able to apply each of the four reflection methods, and complete two reflection essays and a character-study project.

## COURSE MATERIALS

### Required Materials

- A Bible (any translation)
- A journal or notebook dedicated to weekly reflections
- A pen or pencil

### Optional Materials

- Colored pens or highlighters for journaling

### Required Text

The Bible — translation of the student/family's choice

## COURSE SCHEDULE

### Quarter 1 (Sept.–Oct.): S.O.A.P.

| Week | Topic | Reading / Resources |
|---|---|---|
| 1 — Sept. 4 | Orientation Week | N/A |
| 2 — Sept. 11 | Creation | S.O.A.P.: Genesis 1–2:4 |
| 3 — Sept. 18 | Moses and the burning bush | S.O.A.P.: Exodus 3:1–14 |
| 4 — Sept. 25 | The fiery furnace | S.O.A.P.: Daniel 3 |
| 5 — Oct. 2 | Trust in God | S.O.A.P.: Proverbs 3:1–12 |
| 6 — Oct. 9 | The Lord is my shepherd | S.O.A.P.: Psalm 23 |
| 7 — Oct. 16 | Fruit of the Spirit | S.O.A.P.: Galatians 5:16–26 |
| 8 — Oct. 23 | The vine and the branches | S.O.A.P.: John 15 |
| 9 — Oct. 30 | Jonah runs from God | S.O.A.P.: Jonah 1 |

### Quarter 2 (Nov.–Jan.): 3-2-1

| Week | Topic | Reading / Resources |
|---|---|---|
| 1 — Nov. 6 | Living sacrifices | 3-2-1: Romans 12:1–2 |
| 2 — Nov. 13 | New heavens and new earth | 3-2-1: Revelation 21:1–7 |
| 3 — Nov. 20 | Doubting Thomas | 3-2-1: John 20:24–29 |
| 4 — Dec. 4 | Stepping onto the water | 3-2-1: Matthew 14 |
| 5 — Dec. 11 | Lazarus raised from the dead | 3-2-1: John 11:1–43 |
| 6 — Dec. 18 | Christ's ambassadors | 3-2-1: 2 Corinthians 5:11–20 |
| 7 — Jan. 8 | Faith | 3-2-1: Hebrews 11 |
| 8 — Jan. 15 | Reflection essay work day | Work day |

### Quarter 3 (Jan.–Apr.): Two Truths and a Feeling

| Week | Topic | Reading / Resources |
|---|---|---|
| 1 — Jan. 22 | Sermon on the Mount, part 1 | Two Truths and a Feeling: Matthew 5:1–12 |
| 2 — Jan. 29 | Sermon on the Mount, part 2 | Two Truths and a Feeling: Matthew 5:13–26 |
| 3 — Feb. 5 | Sermon on the Mount, part 3 | Two Truths and a Feeling: Matthew 5:43–6:4 |
| 4 — Feb. 12 | Sermon on the Mount, part 4 | Two Truths and a Feeling: Matthew 6:19–24 |
| 5 — Feb. 26 | Sermon on the Mount, part 5 | Two Truths and a Feeling: Matthew 6:25–34 |
| 6 — Mar. 5 | Sermon on the Mount, part 6 | Two Truths and a Feeling: Matthew 7:1–6 |
| 7 — Mar. 12 | Sermon on the Mount, part 7 | Two Truths and a Feeling: Matthew 7:7–14 |
| 8 — Mar. 19 | Sermon on the Mount, part 8 | Two Truths and a Feeling: Matthew 7:15–29 |

| Week | Topic | Reading / Resources |
|---|---|---|
| 9 — Mar. 26 | Reflection essay work day | Work day |

### Quarter 4 (Apr.–May): Interview the Character

| Week | Topic | Reading / Resources |
|---|---|---|
| 1 — Apr. 9 | The story of Joseph | Interview the Character: Joseph, Genesis 37–45 |
| 2 — Apr. 16 | The burning bush | Interview the Character: Moses, Exodus 3 |
| 3 — Apr. 23 | Esther | Interview the Character: Esther, Esther |
| 4 — Apr. 30 | David and Goliath | Interview the Character: David, 1 Samuel 17 |
| 5 — May 7 | Jesus in the garden; Mary called | Interview the Character: Jesus or Mary, Luke 1:26–56; Matthew 26:36–46 |
| 6 — May 14 | Peter denies Jesus; Jesus restores Peter | Interview the Character: Peter, Matthew 26:69–75; John 21:15–19 |
| 7 — May 21 | Road to Damascus | Interview the Character: Paul, Acts 9 |
| 8 — May 28 | Character Presentations | N/A |

## ASSIGNMENT SCHEDULE

| Date | Subject |
|---|---|
| Oct. 30 | S.O.A.P. journal entries due |
| Jan. 15 | Honest conversation/reflection essay due |
| Mar. 26 | Reflection essay due |
| May 28 | Character Presentation Due |

## ADDITIONAL INFORMATION AND RESOURCES

### Weekly Reflection Methods

Each quarter uses a different method for weekly Scripture reflection.

S.O.A.P. (Q1): a fill-in-the-blank format — Verse, One thing I noticed, One way I'll live this out today, Prayer.

3-2-1 (Q2): 3 words that stuck out, 2 questions the student has, 1 thing they're taking away.

Two Truths and a Feeling (Q3): two things the passage teaches (facts/truths), and one feeling or thought it gave the student.

Interview the Character (Q4): 3 questions the student would like to ask the biblical character being studied.

### Grading & Communication

Students are assessed on weekly participation and reflections, the two quarterly reflection essays (Q2 and Q3), and the Q4 character presentation.